

Course Code: BCC 106
Course Title: Principles of Marketing
Marks: 100
Credit: 3 hours
(Written: 75, Internal Evaluation: 20 and Viva: 05)

Course Objectives:

The basic objectives of this course are to provide you with a broad introduction to marketing concepts, help you understand the factors that influence marketing decisions, and focus attention on the vital role of marketing in today's global economy. The specific objectives for student learning under this broad goal are:

1. To understand how organizations identify customers and their wants/needs.
2. To comprehend marketing decisions, based upon the combination of product, price, promotion and distribution elements. In this course, you will study the marketing mix and its implications in the marketing planning process.
3. To understand how marketing is carried out by organizations to meet the requirements of domestic and international buyers; both households and businesses; within the bounds of ethics and the legal environment.
4. To understand fundamental frameworks and methods and develop analytical skills through the learned methods and concepts in solving marketing problems.
5. To provide you with a firm foundation in marketing theory and marketing lexicon.
6. To relate the impact of marketing and its integration with your own major or field of interest.

Course contents:

1. **Introduction to Marketing:** Definition of marketing, Understanding the marketplace and customer needs, Designing a customer-driven marketing strategy, Marketing plan and program, Managing customer relationships, Capturing value from customers.
2. **Company and Marketing Strategy:** Company-wide strategic planning, Partnering to build customer relationships, Marketing strategy and marketing mix, Managing the effort and marketing return on investment.
3. **Analyzing the Marketing Environment:** The microenvironment of the company, The macro-environment of the company, Responding to the marketing environment.
4. **Customer Insights through Marketing Information and Research:** Marketing information and customer insights, Assessing information needs and developing data, Conducting marketing research, Analyzing and using marketing information.

5. **Customer Value-Driven Marketing Strategy: Market segmentation:** Segmenting consumer, Business and international markets, Requirement for effective segmentation.

Market targeting: Evaluating market segments, Selecting target market segments.

Differentiation and Positioning: Positioning maps, Choosing a differentiation and positioning strategy, Communicating and delivering the chosen position.

6. **Product, Services, and Brands:** Levels of product and services, Classification of product and services, Product and service decisions, Service Marketing, Branding Strategy.
7. **Pricing:** Factors influencing setting prices, Customer perception of value, Value-based pricing, Cost-based pricing, Other internal and external consideration affecting price decisions.
8. **Marketing Channels:** Supply and the value delivery network, The nature and importance of marketing channels, Channel behavior and organization: Vertical Marketing Systems, Horizontal Marketing Systems, Multichannel Marketing Systems.
9. **Integrated Marketing Communication:** The marketing communication mix, Developing effective marketing communication, Setting the total promotion budget and mix.
10. **Marketing in digital age and ethical backdrop:** Rapid growth of direct and digital marketing, Forms of direct and digital marketing, The internet and the digital age: Online marketing, Social media marketing, Mobile marketing. Sustainable Marketing, Social responsibility, Social criticisms of marketing, and Marketing ethics.

Basic Text: Principles of Marketing by Philip Kotler and Gary Armstrong (17th Edition)